

ASUS A7V266-E

Good performance but at a price

ASUS A7V266-E is a well laid out and roomy board that comes with an excellent manual. The board was very



stable in our tests and returned great results. It blazed through the Photoshop 6.1 test where it took a total average time of just 63.1 seconds to crunch through the 21 filters it was subjected to—that's about 30 per cent faster than its predecessors, the KT133A-based boards. In our other tests, encoding a 50

MB wave file took just 20 seconds while converting a 53 MB MPEG file to AVI took just 99 seconds. In the Content Creation test too we logged a score of 81.6, which was among the highest we have ever logged.

The excellent results in the Content Creation test suggest good performance in most business and office applications. It has a very good layout, documentation and construction. The only negative is the high price tag.

SPECIFICATIONS:
Supports socket A (462) processors from AMD Athlon Thunderbird, Athlon XP and Duron, Slots: five PCI, one ACR, one AGP Pro, three DIMM, Onboard audio and Promise RAID Controller

Price: Rs 13,000
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260258
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.rptechindia.com

ASUS A7V266-E		A-
Performance	★★★★	
Build Quality	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★	
Features	★★★★ 1/2	
OVERALL	★★★★	

Hewlett-Packard Scanjet 2200C

Slow on the scan

The HP Scanjet 2200C scanner is up and running the moment you plug it in the USB port. The bundled Adobe ActiveShare 1.5 offers entry-level image-editing features. The scanner is pretty slow to start up and failed to pick up subtle variations in the brightness of images. The results in the image quality tests were good and

it picked up little details present in different areas of the photograph.

This slim and light device features a 42-bit scanning engine and the bundled TWAIN driver has built-in optical character recognition capability. A separate OCR software would, however, have been better.

SPECIFICATIONS:
600x1200 dpi, 8.5x11.7 inch scanning area, scan to Web capability, USB interface, **Benchmarks:** 18.65 seconds preview time, 8 seconds warm-up time, 20 seconds to test and scan image at 300 dpi



Price: Rs 5,999
Contact: Hewlett-Packard India
Phone: 011-6826000
Web site: www.hpindia.com

HP Scanjet 2200C		B+
Performance	★★★★	
Build Quality	★★★★ 1/2	
Value for Money	★★★★ 1/2	
Features	★★★★ 1/2	
OVERALL	★★★★ 1/2	

Sony DDU1621

The ripper

This 16x DVD drive features a proprietary technology called 'Sony Advanced Spindle' that enhances the ability of the laser to reliably read information from unbalanced or uneven disks. In the tests, the drive was very fast at ripping an audio CD track to a wave file: it extracted a 50 MB audio track to the hard disk in just 29 seconds and reached the maximum speed of 12x. The scores faltered to 1990 in CD Winbench 99 test—other 16x DVD drives usually score about 2100 in this test. This would reflect in real-world tasks such as installing large amounts of software from the CD or while copying data from a CD or DVD media. It also logged a slightly high access time of 119 ms, which would



lead to longer times at detecting and reading from CDs. The drive is priced reasonably and is particularly good at reading used and slightly scarred media because of the built-in error correcting technology.

SPECIFICATIONS:
16x DVD speed, 40x CD speed, 512 KB onboard buffer, Sony Advanced Spindle technology for increased stability
Benchmarks: 1990 in CD Winbench 99, 119 ms access time in SiSoft Sandra 2001te, 29 seconds for Digital Audio Extraction (DAE) of a 50 MB audio track

Price: Rs 5,300
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260256
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Sony DDU1621		B+
Performance	★★★★ 1/2	
Build Quality	★★★★ 1/2	
Value for Money	★★★★ 1/2	
Features	★★★★ 1/2	
OVERALL	★★★★ 1/2	